

Shramay Palta

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Research Interests

Natural Language Processing, Natural Language Reasoning and Inference, Commonsense Reasoning, Human-AI Alignment, Reasoning under Uncertainty, Explainability and Interpretability

Education

- 2021–present **University of Maryland, College Park**, *Ph.D. in Computer Science*
Thesis: Graded Judgments of Plausibility in Commonsense Reasoning
Advisor: Professor Rachel Rudinger
- 2021–2023 **University of Maryland, College Park**, *M.S. in Computer Science*
Advisor: Professor Rachel Rudinger
- 2017–2021 **BITS Pilani (Pilani Campus)**, *B.E. in Electrical and Electronics Engineering*
Advisors: Professor Ashok Agrawala (UMD) and Professor Navneet Goyal (BITS)

Professional Experience

- 2025 **Research Intern, Microsoft**
Hosted by Dr. Mengting Wan (Office of Applied Research) and Michael Bentley (Office AI Science). Developed a model router for enterprise user queries, engineering a solution that strictly optimized for accuracy, operational cost, and system latency.
- 2024 **Research Intern, Microsoft Research**
Hosted by Dr. Scott Counts. Built and evaluated a classifier for user and agent expertise in AI chat interactions, which led to a research paper on the implications of User-AI expertise alignment. The classifier is scheduled for adoption by IDEAS in E+D.
- 2019 **Data Science Intern, TurnoutNow**
Used real-time location data from IoT BLE Beacons and natural language generation tools with live data connections to generate narratives for end users.

Publications

Preprints, Under Review and Works in Progress.

Work in Progress **Shramay Palta**, Rachel Rudinger. *The Ghost in the Discourse: Tracing Semantic Leakage to Implicit Discourse Connectives*.

Conference Papers

- ACL 2026 **Shramay Palta**, Peter Rankel, Sarah Wiegrefe, Rachel Rudinger. *Arguments that Alter Minds: LLM Rationales Sway Human (and LLM) Notions of Plausibility*. Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics.
- IJCNLP-
AACL 2025 **Shramay Palta**, Nirupama Chandrasekaran, Rachel Rudinger, Scott Counts. *Speaking the Right Language: The Impact of Expertise (Mis)Alignment in User-AI Interactions*. International Joint Conference on Natural Language Processing & Asia-Pacific Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics.

- EMNLP 2024 Findings **Shramay Palta**, Nishant Balepur, Peter Rankel, Sarah Wiegrefe, Marine Carpuat, Rachel Rudinger. *Plausibly Problematic Questions in Multiple-Choice Benchmarks for Commonsense Reasoning*. Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing.
- ECCV 2024 Gowthami Somepalli, Anubhav Gupta, Kamal Gupta, **Shramay Palta**, Micah Goldblum, Jonas Geiping, Abhinav Shrivastava, Tom Goldstein. *Investigating Style Similarity in Diffusion Models*. European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV).
- ACL 2024 Findings Nishant Balepur, **Shramay Palta**, Rachel Rudinger. *It's Not Easy Being Wrong: Large Language Models Struggle with Process of Elimination Reasoning*. Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics.
- ACL 2023 Findings **Shramay Palta**, Rachel Rudinger. *FORK: A Bite-Sized Test Set for Probing Culinary Cultural Biases in Commonsense Reasoning Models*. Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics.

Selected Invited Talks

- 2025 **Graded Judgments of Plausibility in Commonsense Reasoning**, *Invited Guest Lecture*, Rutgers University Graduate NLP Class.
- 2024 **Uncertainty and its Impact on Commonsense Reasoning**, *Guest Lecture*, UMD Graduate NLP Seminar.
- 2023 **Prompting, In-context Learning, and Instruct Tuning**, *Guest Lecture*, UMD Undergraduate Natural Language Processing course.

Skills

- Languages: Python, R
- Frameworks and Libraries: PyTorch, HuggingFace, pandas, numpy, sklearn
- Tools: Git, LaTeX

Selected Honor and Awards

- 2026 **Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant and CS Travel Grant**, *UMD*
Awarded the Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant and CS Travel Grant (worth \$1,400) for presenting my research at ACL 2026.
- 2021–2023 **Dean's Fellowship and Chair's Fellowship**, *UMD*
Awarded the Graduate School Dean's Fellowship and the Chair's Fellowship Award for outstanding academic achievement.

Voluntary Service

Reviewing

- ACL Rolling Review (ARR): 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Other

- Reviewer: UMD CS Graduate Admissions Committee
- President: CS GradCo: an organization aimed to improve the experiences of all CS graduate students as they progress through their program.